AI Images: Free Credits, Cost and Profit Summary

Short answers for management on what the free monthly AI credits cost JewlX, whether image generation makes or loses money, and where the supplier bill lands. Figures cover every AI image generated from 20 March to 30 October 2026, customer accounts only unless stated. Source: live database wallet rows; full detail in AI-Image-Generation-Report.pdf.

1. The three questions, answered

How much do we spend on free credits each month?

Every account gets $22.50 of free AI credits a month, which is 312 free images at the current price of $0.072. In October 2026 customers used **$108.97** of free credits at client price. The real supplier cost behind those free images was about **$60.54** (client price divided by the 1.8 mark-up). September was $60.33 at client price, about $33.52 real cost. Since launch, $244.60 of free credits have been given away, costing JewlX roughly $135.89 in supplier fees.

How much do we lose?

Image generation has not yet covered its own supplier cost in any month since May 2026. In October customers paid **$71.32** from their wallets while the estimated supplier bill for all their images was **$100.16**, a loss of **$28.84**. September lost $18.89. Lifetime, customer accounts have paid $104.60 against about $176.37 of supplier cost: **a net loss of $71.77** ($85.91 once internal/test accounts are included). Only 4 customer accounts have ever paid anything; the rest stay inside the free allowance.

Is the cost of free credits taken from our Lovable Pro plan, or charged extra?

The three image functions (ring preview, grillz preview, custom-enquiry preview) send every request to the **Lovable AI Gateway** using the workspace key, with Google and OpenRouter only as fallbacks if Lovable fails. So the supplier bill for all images, free or paid, lands on the **JewlX Lovable workspace as AI usage**. It is not charged to a separate Google or OpenAI account. Lovable AI usage is separate from the editor credits used for building; the Pro plan includes a monthly AI usage allowance, and anything above it is billed to the workspace as extra usage. Whether our roughly $100 a month of image cost sits inside that allowance or is already overflowing into extra charges is not visible from the code or the database; it is shown on the Lovable workspace Usage page. Checking October there will also confirm the supplier estimate used in this report.

2. Month by month: images, who paid, what Lovable billed

Customer accounts. *Free-credit images* are images whose cost JewlX absorbed; *wallet images* were paid by the client (includes the one image a month where the free allowance ran out part-way). *Lovable bill* is the estimated supplier cost of all images that month; the *unrecovered* part is the supplier cost of the free-credit images.

Month	Images	Free images	Wallet images	Free credits (client price)	Unrecovered (Lovable bill for free images)	Cash from client wallets	Lovable bill, all images (est.)	Profit / loss
2026-04	9	0	9	$0.00	$0.00	$0.37	$0.21	$0.16
2026-05	111	111	0	$7.99	$4.44	$0.00	$4.44	-$4.44
2026-06	134	134	0	$9.65	$5.36	$0.00	$5.36	-$5.36
2026-07	60	60	0	$4.32	$2.40	$0.00	$2.40	-$2.40
2026-08	300	300	0	$21.60	$12.00	$0.00	$12.00	-$12.00
2026-09	1,295	837	458	$60.33	$33.52	$32.91	$51.80	-$18.89
2026-10	2,504	1,512	992	$108.97	$60.54	$71.32	$100.16	-$28.84
Total	**4,413**	**2,954**	**1,459**	**$212.86**	**$118.26**	**$104.60**	**$176.37**	**-$71.77**

Internal/test accounts (JewlX, fbe, Lumière) add 577 images and about $22.02 of supplier cost on top, of which $7.83 was paid from internal wallets. March and April 2026 ran at older, lower prices, so their supplier estimate is slightly high.

3. Summary for management

- **Volume is growing fast**: 1,295 customer images in September, 2,504 in October, from 14 active accounts.
- **Most of it is free**: 60% of October's images were covered by the $22.50 monthly free allowance. Only 4 customer accounts have ever reached the point where their wallet is charged.
- **Clients pay less than Lovable bills us**: October cash in $71.32, estimated Lovable bill $100.16, loss $28.84. The loss has grown every month since August because each new account first consumes its free images.
- **Lifetime**: 4,413 customer images, $104.60 collected, about $176.37 paid to the supplier, net **-$71.77**. Free credits account for $212.86 at client price ($118.26 real cost).
- **Where the money goes**: all image supplier cost is billed to the JewlX Lovable workspace as AI usage. Confirm on the Lovable Usage page whether October stayed inside the Pro plan's included allowance or spilled into extra charges.

The lever is the monthly free credit setting ($22.50, raised from $2.50 in May 2026 when a one-time welcome bonus was put into the monthly field). Lowering it, or separating a one-time welcome bonus from the monthly allowance, directly reduces the unrecovered column above. The data itself is accurate; the loss is a pricing decision, not a reporting error.